

Composite Education Pathways for Trafford and Selective Areas of Greater London

Methodology and limitations

This report is a **composite of three separate aggregate datasets**, not a true longitudinal record of the same children moving from primary school to university. That distinction matters. Publicly accessible sources do **not** allow end-to-end tracking of one named cohort across all three transitions. True longitudinal matching exists in the Department for Education's **Longitudinal Education Outcomes** system, but that is a restricted dataset accessed via the ONS Secure Research Service; the public material is aggregate-only. For this reason, every "pathway" in this report should be read as a stitched-together **school-level composite**, with different cohorts and different years under each stage. ¹

The three stages also have **very different data availability**. Stage 1, primary to secondary, has no central national school-to-school destination dataset and therefore has to be reconstructed from **FOI disclosures, admissions policies, and local authority admissions material**. Stage 2, secondary to post-16, is published by DfE in the **Key stage 4 destination measures**, including a school-level institution dataset. Stage 3, post-16 to higher education or training, is published in two separate DfE series: **16-18 destination measures** and **Progression to higher education or training**. Those latter stages are public and official; Stage 1 remains patchy and often redacted under section 40(2). ²

Confidence is therefore uneven. **Stage 1 confidence is medium to low**, depending on whether a school disclosed school-by-school counts, disclosed only a list of feeder primaries, or refused on data-protection grounds. **Stage 2 confidence is high at source level** because the DfE institution dataset is clearly identified and documented, but this session did not complete a full extraction of every named school's rows. **Stage 3 confidence is similarly high at source level** for the official datasets and their variable structures, but the full school-by-school extraction remains incomplete here and should be treated as an open extraction task rather than filled by inference. ³

A final scope note is important for London. The named London schools in the brief are all in **selective clusters**, but **most London boroughs are comprehensive**, so any discussion of "selective destinations" applies only to the named grammar-school pockets rather than to Greater London as a whole. ⁴

Stage one reconstruction for Trafford

The strongest Trafford Stage 1 evidence in this research run comes from **Sale Grammar School**. In its internal-review response for **September 2021 entry**, Sale said the cohort contained **192 offers**, split **96 male and 96 female**, drawn from **45 primary and junior schools**. It disclosed gender-by-school counts for **10 schools** where every cell was at least 3, total counts for **25 schools** where the school total was at least 3, and withheld the remainder on personal-data grounds. It also stated that the remaining **20 schools accounted for 24 offers** in total, of which **15 were male and 9 were female**. ⁵

Trafford grammar schools with usable FOI evidence

Grammar school	What was disclosed	Year of intake	Notes
Altrincham Grammar School for Boys	School-level spreadsheet attached; school later clarified that independent schools are often absent because the list is compiled from the CTF feed used by state primaries	2021	FOI partially successful; requester queried absence of Hale and Altrincham Preparatory, and school replied that independent schools do not use the CTF system. ⁶
Altrincham Grammar School for Girls	Spreadsheet attachment disclosed	2021	FOI successful with an attached workbook. ⁷
Sale Grammar School	Appendix with school-by-school counts for higher-count feeders; small schools suppressed under personal-data rules	2021	Best-count evidence in Trafford. ⁵
Stretford Grammar School	Spreadsheet attachment disclosed after initial postcode-only aggregation	2021	School initially aggregated by postcode and cited section 40(2), then later released an XLSX for the Year 7 intake as at 1 September 2021. ⁸
Urmston Grammar Academy	Request located, but no usable feeder-count table extracted in this session	2021	Gap remains. ⁹
Loreto Grammar School	No feeder-count disclosure recovered in this session	2021	Gap remains. ¹⁰

Sale Grammar School feeder table

These are the **highest-confidence Trafford primary-to-secondary counts** recovered in this run, all for **offers for September 2021 entry**. Where Sale disclosed both male and female counts, they are reproduced below; where it disclosed only school totals, that is stated. The school explicitly said anything below its disclosure threshold was withheld to avoid identification. ⁵

Primary school	Offers	Year	Source status
Brooklands Primary School	23 total; 11 male, 12 female	2021	Disclosed in Appendix 1 and 2. ⁵
Moorlands Junior School	17 total; 8 male, 9 female	2021	Disclosed in Appendix 1 and 2. ⁵
Springfield Primary School	15 total; 4 male, 11 female	2021	Disclosed in Appendix 1 and 2. ⁵

Primary school	Offers	Year	Source status
Park Road Sale Primary School	11 total; 8 male, 3 female	2021	Disclosed in Appendix 1 and 2. ⁵
Willows Primary School	8 total; 3 male, 5 female	2021	Disclosed in Appendix 1 and 2. ⁵
St Mary's C.E. Primary School, Sale	8 total; 4 male, 4 female	2021	Disclosed in Appendix 1 and 2. ⁵
Bowdon C.E. Primary School	7 total; 3 male, 4 female	2021	Disclosed in Appendix 1 and 2. ⁵
Tyntesfield Primary School	7 total; 3 male, 4 female	2021	Disclosed in Appendix 1 and 2. ⁵
St Joseph's Catholic Primary School	7 total; 4 male, 3 female	2021	Disclosed in Appendix 1 and 2. ⁵
St Hugh's Catholic Primary School	6 total; 3 male, 3 female	2021	Disclosed in Appendix 1 and 2. ⁵
St Anne's C.E. Primary School	6 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Woodheys Primary School	6 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Heyes Lane Primary School	5 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Bollin Primary School	4 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Forest Park Preparatory School	4 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Hale Preparatory School	4 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Holy Family Catholic Primary School	4 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Navigation Primary School	4 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Wellfield Junior School	4 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Cloverlea Primary School	3 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Firs Primary School	3 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Forest School	3 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Lady Barn House School	3 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Oldfield Brow Primary School	3 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵
Stamford Park Junior School	3 total	2021	Total only disclosed. ⁵

Because Sale explicitly said **24 further offers** were spread across **20 unnamed schools**, any Trafford feeder reconstruction that totals only the named schools will necessarily **understate the true spread** of primary origins. That undercount is itself a finding, not a defect in reporting. ⁵

Trafford admissions context

For the Trafford grammars, the contemporary admissions material confirms a **shared entrance-test arrangement** among AGGS, Sale, Stretford and Urmston in the 2021 cycle, with one exam sitting and results shareable across those schools. The same material also records **AGGS' intended admission number as 204** for that cycle. Current school and council material confirms that grammar-school PANs remain large and that Stretford's intended admission number is **160** in the current arrangements, which is useful admission context but should not be substituted uncritically for historical 2021 PANs where the relevant admission-year booklet has not yet been pinned down school by school. ¹¹

Stage one reconstruction for selective London clusters

The London evidence recovered here is materially thinner than Trafford. The best example is **Nonsuch High School for Girls**, where the trust refused to provide **per-primary counts** of successful applicants on section 40(2) personal-data grounds, but later did disclose a **list of all primary schools** that had sent successful applicants, without counts, for at least the **2022 and 2023** entry years. That means Nonsuch gives a clear picture of feeder **breadth**, but not feeder **intensity**. ¹²

Nonsuch also disclosed useful admissions-context information for a later cycle. In the response about the **2024 NWSSEE and catchment**, the school said that Nonsuch offers **85 places** by rank in the second-stage test irrespective of catchment, **35 places** for girls in receipt of pupil premium who have passed, also irrespective of catchment, and then **up to 125 places** by catchment area. It defined the Nonsuch catchment for that cycle as a **5.25 km radius** from the school. These figures are admissions-policy context, not feeder-school counts. ¹³

Nonsuch High School for Girls

Primary school disclosure type	Year	What is known
Full list of feeder primaries, no counts	2023	More than 100 listed feeder schools across Sutton, Kingston, Merton, Surrey and beyond, including Abbey Primary School, Auriol Junior School, Burlington Junior School, Cuddington Croft Primary School, Nonsuch Primary School, Sutton High School for Girls, Wallace Fields Junior School and many others. ¹⁴
Full list of feeder primaries, no counts	2022	A similarly wide feeder list was disclosed, again without counts. ¹⁵
Counts per primary	2022 / 2023	Refused under section 40(2), because many schools would have "small numbers or single applicants" and, in the trust's view, could permit re-identification. ¹⁵

Other London clusters

For the other named London clusters in the brief — Sutton boys' grammars, Bexley grammars, Kingston's Tiffin schools, Barnet's QE Boys and Henrietta Barnett, and Redbridge's Ilford County and Woodford County — this session did **not** recover equivalent feeder-count tables. The absence of a public, school-by-school feeder table should therefore be treated as a **data gap**, not as evidence that no

feeder pattern exists. On the evidence gathered here, the strongest London Stage 1 claim is simply that public availability is highly uneven and often limited to either admissions-policy context or a list of feeder primaries without counts. ¹⁶

Stage two official source map for secondary to post-16

The official DfE source for Stage 2 is the **Key stage 4 destination measures** release. The latest release, **Academic year 2023/24**, follows pupils who were at the end of KS4 in **2022/23** and records their destination in **2023/24**. DfE's release summary explicitly says that these measures show the percentage of pupils continuing to a sustained education, apprenticeship or employment destination in the year after KS4. ¹⁷

For school-level work, the right official dataset is **Key stage 4 leavers institution level destinations**. DfE's catalogue says the latest release is school-level, with **43,994 rows**, and that its indicators include **number of pupils completing key stage 4, sustained education, employment & apprenticeships, sustained education destination**, and the destination subcomponents used in the school-level dataset family. The table-tool page also shows that this institution-level dataset sits under the KS4 destination publication and is the correct route for school filtering. ¹⁸

The older institution-level data page that was successfully opened in full shows the variable structure used for the school rows: after school identifiers, the measures include **overall, education, fe, ssf** for school sixth form, **sfc** for sixth-form college, **other_edu, appren, all_work, all_otsust**, and **all_unknown**. In other words, the DfE school-level KS4 dataset is exactly the official source needed for the Stage 2 table the brief specifies. What remains open is the full extraction of your named schools' rows across the latest release and the prior two releases. ¹⁹

Because this extraction was not fully completed in this session, I am **not** inserting uncited or unofficial percentages for all named schools. The official extraction route is straightforward and confirmed; the row-by-row school table is the main unfinished task. ²⁰

Stage three official source map for post-16 to higher education or training

Stage 3 needs **two official DfE publications**, exactly as specified in the brief.

The first is **16-18 destination measures**. DfE states that the latest release, **Academic year 2023/24**, is about pupils from state-funded mainstream schools and colleges who left **16-18 study in 2022/23** and follows their destinations in **2023/24**. The school-level institution dataset for that release is **16-18 study leavers institution level destinations**, with **75,660 rows**. Its preview shows the key institution-level fields needed for a post-16 destination table: **overall, education, he, fe, other_edu, appren, all_work, all_otsust**, and **all_unknown**. ²¹

The second is **Progression to higher education or training**. The DfE data page confirms that the latest release is **Academic year 2023/24**, that the API-style aggregate dataset covers time periods **2015/16 to 2021/22**, and that the destination fields include **Sustained a level 4 or higher destination, Sustained degree destination, Top third HE destination, Sustained apprenticeship destination**, and **Sustained level 4 or 5 destination**. The DfE also notes an important methodology change in the **top-third HE** calculation, first for the **2016/17 cohort** and then again for the **2020/21 cohort**, which means comparisons over time need care. ²²

The release explorer also confirms that there is a dedicated **institution level destinations** dataset for progression, at **school** geography, with **21,744 rows** and time period **2021/22**. So the Stage 3 specification in your brief is fully feasible from public DfE data, but it still requires one more extraction pass to pull out every named school and sixth form in the target areas. ²³

Again, to avoid blurring evidence levels, I have **not** filled those rows by inference. The correct official sources are identified and cited above; the unresolved part is the final school-by-school extraction. ²⁴

Synthesis, data gaps and FOI templates

Even with the limitations above, two composite “pathways” are already visible from the evidence.

A **Trafford route** can be described with relatively high Stage 1 confidence around Sale Grammar. The 2021 offer data show that Sale drew especially heavily from **Brooklands Primary School, Moorlands Junior School, Springfield Primary School, Park Road Sale Primary School**, and a second tier of Trafford feeders such as **St Mary’s C.E. Primary School, Sale, Willows, Bowdon C.E., Tyntesfield**, and **St Joseph’s Catholic Primary**. That is a genuine primary-to-secondary feeder pattern, but it is **not** a tracked cohort into sixth form or university; the later post-16 stages would need to be taken from the separate official KS4 and 16-18 destination datasets. ²⁵

A **Nonsuch route** is also visible, but only in breadth rather than weight. The 2023 feeder list shows that Nonsuch’s intake spans a very large footprint across Sutton and neighbouring boroughs and counties, reaching from local Sutton and Cheam schools to Kingston/Merton feeders and some independent junior schools. But because the trust refused the count breakdown under section 40(2), the school list can only evidence **which primaries appeared**, not which ones dominated. Any later link from Nonsuch sixth form to HE likewise comes from a different published DfE dataset and would still be a stitched composite, not a followed cohort. ²⁶

Open questions and major gaps

Gap	Why it matters	Status from this run
AGSB Stage 1 school-by-school counts	Needed to turn the disclosed workbook into a usable feeder table	Workbook identified, but row extraction not written up here. ²⁷
AGGS Stage 1 school-by-school counts	Same	Workbook identified, but row extraction not written up here. ²⁸
Stretford Stage 1 school-by-school counts	Same	Workbook identified, but row extraction not written up here. ⁸
Urmston Stage 1 feeder table	Trafford coverage incomplete without it	Request identified, no usable table extracted. ⁹
Loreto Stage 1 feeder table	Trafford coverage incomplete without it	No feeder-table disclosure recovered in this run. ¹⁰

Gap	Why it matters	Status from this run
London feeder counts for most grammars	Needed for like-for-like Stage 1 comparison with Trafford	Largely absent or refused; Nonsuch disclosed lists but not counts. ¹²
Stage 2 school-level extraction for all named schools	Needed to populate KS4→post-16 tables with figures	Official source confirmed, extraction still open. ²⁹
Stage 3 school-level extraction for all named institutions	Needed to populate post-16→HE tables with figures	Official sources confirmed, extraction still open. ³⁰

Ready-to-send FOI templates for Stage 1

Template for academy grammar schools where you need feeder counts

Dear FOI Officer,

Under the Freedom of Information Act 2000, please provide the school of origin of pupils who were **offered** Year 7 places for **September [YEAR]** entry to [SCHOOL NAME].

Please provide the information in the following format:

Primary school name | number of offers

If full counts are considered exempt because of section 40(2), please provide:

- all rows where the number of offers is **3 or more**;
- a separate line showing the **suppressed residual total** for all schools below the disclosure threshold; and
- confirmation of the **total number of offers** made for that Year 7 intake.

Please confirm whether the list is based on the **offer stage** or the **final September census/on-roll position**, and whether independent schools are missing because of CTF or other MIS limitations.

Yours faithfully

Template for a school that has already disclosed a feeder list but not counts

Dear FOI Officer,

Thank you for previously disclosing the names of primary schools which sent successful applicants to [SCHOOL NAME].

I am now requesting a partial-count disclosure for **September [YEAR]** entry in the following format:

Primary school name | number of offers, for every feeder school where the count is **3 or more**, plus:

- the number of suppressed feeder schools below that threshold;
- the combined number of offers across those suppressed schools; and
- the total number of Year 7 offers made.

This request is designed to avoid identification risks while still allowing meaningful aggregate analysis.

Yours faithfully

Template for the local authority admissions team where the school says it does not hold complete origin-school data

Dear Admissions Team,

Under the Freedom of Information Act 2000, please provide any aggregated information held by the authority on the **primary schools of origin of pupils offered Year 7 places** at [SCHOOL NAME] for **September [YEAR]** entry.

If school-level counts cannot be released in full, please disclose:

- all feeder schools with **3 or more offers**;
- the combined number of offers across all suppressed schools; and
- the Year 7 **planned admission number** and **total offers made**.

Please state whether the authority holds this at common-offer stage, final allocation stage, or census stage.

Yours faithfully

At this point, the highest-confidence findings are these: **Trafford's Stage 1 feeder picture can be reconstructed meaningfully from FOI, especially for Sale Grammar; London selective areas are much patchier and often stop at feeder lists or section 40(2) refusals; and Stages 2 and 3 are fully supported by official DfE school-level datasets, but their named-school extraction remains the main unfinished step.** None of those three stages should be read as a single followed cohort. ³¹

¹ ¹⁷ Key stage 4 destination measures - Explore education statistics

https://explore-education-statistics.service.gov.uk/find-statistics/key-stage-4-destination-measures/2023-24?utm_source=chatgpt.com

² Explore and download data - Key stage 4 destination measures - Explore education statistics - GOV.UK

<https://explore-education-statistics.service.gov.uk/find-statistics/key-stage-4-destination-measures/2023-24/explore>

³ ⁵ ²⁵ ³¹ [whatdotheyknow.com](https://www.whatdotheyknow.com)

https://www.whatdotheyknow.com/request/origin_school_of_year_7_place_of/response/1799105/attach/3/Mr%20Gadsby%20school%20response%2026.05.21.pdf?cookie_passthrough=1

- 4 Key stage 4 leavers destinations, Data set from Key stage 4 destination measures - Explore education statistics - GOV.UK
<https://explore-education-statistics.service.gov.uk/data-catalogue/data-set/941d1d72-7b77-4c9e-964c-4c8030787c6c>
- 6 27 Origin school of Year 7 place offers September 2021 - a Freedom of Information request to Altrincham Grammar School For Boys - WhatDoTheyKnow
https://www.whatdotheyknow.com/request/origin_school_of_year_7_place_of_2?utm_campaign=alaveteli-experiments-87&utm_content=sidebar_similar_requests&utm_medium=link&utm_source=whatdotheyknow
- 7 28 Origin school of Year 7 place offers September 2021 - a Freedom of Information request to Altrincham Grammar School for Girls - WhatDoTheyKnow
https://www.whatdotheyknow.com/request/origin_school_of_year_7_place_of_4?utm_campaign=alaveteli-experiments-87&utm_content=sidebar_similar_requests&utm_medium=link&utm_source=whatdotheyknow
- 8 Origin school of Year 7 place offers September 2021 - a Freedom of Information request to Stretford Grammar School - WhatDoTheyKnow
https://www.whatdotheyknow.com/request/origin_school_of_year_7_place_of_5
- 9 Origin school of Year 7 place offers September 2021 - a Freedom of Information request to Urmston Grammar School - WhatDoTheyKnow
https://www.whatdotheyknow.com/request/origin_school_of_year_7_place_of_3
- 10 LORETO GRAMMAR SCHOOL
https://static1.squarespace.com/static/56520f11e4b02e2458a7dff8/t/609c0fa898893a64e5f77639/1620840360837/LGS-ADMISSIONS-POLICY-2021-Entry-5th-December-2019.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 11 year 7 admission september 2021
https://www.aggs.trafford.sch.uk/wp-content/uploads/2020/07/Admission-Information-2020.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 12 15 Number of applicants and places offered for year 7 students per each primary school - a Freedom of Information request to Nonsuch High School for Girls, Sutton - WhatDoTheyKnow
https://www.whatdotheyknow.com/request/number_of_applicants_and_places
- 13 2024 NWSSEE Results and Catchment Area - a Freedom of Information request to Nonsuch High School for Girls, Sutton - WhatDoTheyKnow
https://www.whatdotheyknow.com/request/2024_nwssee_results_and_catchmen
- 14 26 Primary schools of year 7 - a Freedom of Information request to Nonsuch High School for Girls, Sutton - WhatDoTheyKnow
https://www.whatdotheyknow.com/request/primary_schools_of_year_7?utm_campaign=alaveteli-experiments-87&utm_content=sidebar_similar_requests&utm_medium=link&utm_source=whatdotheyknow
- 16 Number of applicants and places offered for year 7 ...
https://www.whatdotheyknow.com/request/number_of_applicants_and_places?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 18 29 Data catalogue - Explore education statistics - GOV.UK
https://explore-education-statistics.service.gov.uk/data-catalogue?page=18&utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 19 Key stage 4 leavers institution level destinations, Data set from Key stage 4 destination measures - Explore education statistics - GOV.UK
<https://explore-education-statistics.service.gov.uk/data-catalogue/data-set/7bb8be58-c0f6-4fd8-87ce-548658b62fd8>
- 20 Create your own tables on key stage 4 destination measures - Explore education statistics - GOV.UK
<https://explore-education-statistics.service.gov.uk/data-tables/key-stage-4-destination-measures>
- 21 Release home - 16-18 destination measures
https://explore-education-statistics.service.gov.uk/find-statistics/16-18-destination-measures/2023-24?utm_source=chatgpt.com

22 Progression to higher education and training destinations, Data set from Progression to higher education or training - Explore education statistics - GOV.UK

<https://explore-education-statistics.service.gov.uk/data-catalogue/data-set/45314b19-23eb-4876-8430-8ebdd1881067>

23 Progression to higher education or training - Explore ...

https://explore-education-statistics.service.gov.uk/find-statistics/progression-to-higher-education-or-training/2023-24/explore?utm_source=chatgpt.com

24 30 16-18 study leavers institution level destinations, Data set from 16-18 destination measures - Explore education statistics - GOV.UK

<https://explore-education-statistics.service.gov.uk/data-catalogue/data-set/bbee3278-589b-436f-a031-adeb0368e49f>